

Dr. Yufeng Liu

Senior Research Associate | Lancaster University

(Research areas: Health Communication; Science Communications and the Public Sphere; AI-Mediated Communication; Lived Experience; Illness Identity; Emotion; Cancer; Chronic Pain; Mental Health; Corpus Linguistics; Discourse Analysis; Cognitive Linguistics; Communication across Languages and Cultures)

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EDUCATION

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| 2023 | Ph.D. in Applied Linguistics
Dissertation: Reframing to Reevaluate: Metaphors in Cross-National COVID-19 News Translation (Recipient of the Faculty of Humanities Distinguished Thesis Award)
The Hong Kong Polytechnic University, Hong Kong SAR |
| 2023 | Academic Visit, University of California Berkeley, United States |
| 2022 | Academic Visit, Lancaster University, United Kingdom |
| 2020 | M.A. in Applied Linguistics
Sichuan University, Chengdu, China |
| 2017 | B.A. in English
Southwest University, Chongqing, China |

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

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| 2023-2026 | Senior Research Associate - Horizon Europe 4D PICTURE project (Principal Investigator: Prof. Paul Rayson, Computer Science; Task Lead: Prof. Elena Semino, Linguistics)
ESRC Centre for Corpus Approaches to Social Science Linguistics and English Language, Lancaster University, United Kingdom <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Worked on the Horizon Europe 4D PICTURE project investigating communication surrounding cancer and chronic pain.• Conducted corpus-assisted discourse analysis of over 43 million words of English online forum data to examine metaphor, framing, illness identity and emotion in relation to cancer and chronic pain.• Collaborated with interdisciplinary and international teams, including linguists, healthcare professionals, palliative care specialists, computer scientists and public contributors across multiple European institutions.• Contributed to stakeholder engagement activities, including regular Public and Patient Involvement (PPI) consultations, integrating lived-experience perspectives into project outcomes.• Co-developed the updated English <i>Metaphor Menu for People</i> |
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Living with Cancer and contributed to Horizon Europe project deliverables.

- Disseminated research findings through journal publications, conference presentations, stakeholder engagement activities, and consortium reporting.

**2026 (Mar-May) Researcher – Energy Coverage in the UK Press (2020–2026)
(Principal Investigator: Prof. Vaclav Brezina)**

ESRC Centre for Corpus Approaches to Social Science, Lancaster University, United Kingdom

- Contributed to a rapid-response corpus-assisted discourse analysis project examining UK newspaper representations of energy and sustainability during major international crises, particularly following the COVID-19 pandemic, Russia-Ukraine war and the conflicts in the Middle East.
- Coordinated the project workflow and distributed research tasks across team members while actively contributing to data collection, corpus compilation, analysis, interpretation of findings and dissemination activities.
- Led the preparation of analytical visualisations and presentation materials and contributed to the delivery of a presentation to the Czech Ambassador to the UK and representatives from the Czech Embassy and Consulate.

2025-2026 Guest Lecturer

Linguistics and English Language, Lancaster University, United Kingdom

- **Delivered a guest lecture on discourse and argumentation** within the postgraduate module **LING421 Corpus Linguistics** (course convenor: Prof. Paul Baker).
- Integrated real-world research examples into lectures to demonstrate how corpus linguistic methods, such as concordance, keyword and collocation analysis, and discourse analysis can be applied to the study of representations of world events and social issues.
- Supported students from diverse backgrounds with different levels of experience in corpus linguistic methods.
- Co-marked 38 postgraduate coursework submissions and provided detailed written feedback.

2024 & 2026 Corpus Linguistics Summer School Workshop Tutor

Linguistics and English Language, Lancaster University, United Kingdom

- Supported hands-on **workshops** for mixed cohorts of undergraduate students, postgraduate researchers and practitioners (68-88 attendees).
- Supported modules include **Corpus-based discourse analysis; Building your own corpus; Online communication; Semantic annotation; Data visualisation.**
- Demonstrated the use of LancsBox, an open-access corpus analysis toolkit developed by Lancaster University's ESRC Centre for Corpus Approaches to Social Science (CASS), to conduct corpus linguistic analyses including concordance, keyword, and collocation analysis.

2020-2023 Teaching Assistant

Department of Language Science and Technology | The Hong Kong Polytechnic University, Hong Kong Special Administrative Region

- Supported postgraduate modules FH6301 Theories of Translation and CBS4801 Translation Studies, and the undergraduate module CBS1CN06P Translation and Chinese Society.
- Designed and led **seminars** using authentic Chinese-English digital and media texts, news examples and student-led textual analysis.
- Supported **assessment** through coursework marking, rubric-based evaluation and written feedback.
- Provided support through Blackboard, Microsoft Teams and face-to-face discussion with students.

RESEARCH PROJECTS & GRANT DEVELOPMENT

2026 (Jan-Apr) Co-Investigator – CARE-AI: Culturally Adaptive and Responsible AI for Equitable Health Communication (Principal Investigator: Amily Guénier)

UK-EU Horizon Pump Priming Collaboration (British Academy funded)

- Provided feedback and comments on the interdisciplinary funding proposal relating to AI, metaphor, and multilingual maternal communication.
- Participated in regular project meetings following the award of funding.
- Contributed feedback and comments on project discussions, research materials, and project reporting from perspectives relating to discourse analysis, metaphor analysis, and intercultural communication.

2025 Lead Applicant – Challenging Stigma and Bridging Knowledge Gaps about Bipolar Disorder through Language in China: A Mixed-Methods Study of Lived Experience and Institutional Messaging (BiLangBridge)

Wellcome Trust Early-Career Award (unfunded proposal)

- Developed a mixed-methods funding proposal from initial concept development through to full proposal submission, focusing on discourses surrounding bipolar disorder in China.
- Coordinated an international collaborator network to support proposal development and future research directions.
- Sought and incorporated feedback from interdisciplinary researchers and stakeholders throughout the proposal development process, strengthening the project's conceptual, methodological, and impact dimensions.
- Gained experience in interdisciplinary grant development, international research collaboration, and impact-oriented research planning through the proposal process.

PUBLICATIONS

Monograph

Liu, Y. (forthcoming). *Metaphor Translation and Ideology Mediation in Global Pandemic News: A Bidirectional Chinese-English Corpus Analysis*. Routledge.

Journal Articles

Liu, Y. (in press). Exploring AI's processing of and responses to metaphors in health-related conversations: A pragmatic analysis of cancer and depression discourse. *Journal of Pragmatics*. [Q1]

Semino, E., Liu, Y., & Demmen, J. (2026). [Metaphors and identities in online descriptions of the experience of pain](#). *Communication & Medicine*, 20(3), 267–276. [Q3]

Liu, Y., & Li, D. (2025). [Metaphors and China's COVID-19 policies: a diachronic analysis of Chinese-English bilingual news editorials](#). *Text & Talk*, 46(1), 53–78. [Q3]

Liu, Y., & Li, D. (2025). [War, Tool, Race or Building? A comparison of vaccine metaphors between \(translated\) media and scientific reports in the age of COVID-19](#). *Journalism*, 26(1), 128–148. [Q1]

Liu, Y., Li, D., & Feng, J. (2025). [Incorporating cross-linguistic and time-based dimensions to Critical Metaphor Analysis: a specialised hands-on analytical approach](#). *Critical Discourse Studies*, 22(6), 664–684. [Q2]

Liu, Y., Semino, E., Rietjens, J., & Payne, S. (2024). [Cancer experience in metaphors: patients, carers, professionals, students – a scoping review](#). *BMJ Supportive & Palliative Care*, 14(3), e2366–e2376. [Q2]

Liu, Y., & Li, D. (2024). [Multimodal metaphor \(re\)framing: a critical analysis of the promotional image of China's Hubei Province in the post-pandemic era on new media](#). *Social Semiotics*, 34(2), 269–288. [Q2]

Liu, Y., & Tay, D. (2023). [Modellability of WAR metaphors across time in cross-national COVID-19 news translation: An insight into ideology manipulation](#). *Lingua*, 286, 103490. [Q2]

Liu, Y., & Li, D. (2022). [The US-China battle over Coronavirus in the news media: Metaphor transfer as a representation of stance mediation](#). *Discourse & Society*, 33(4), 456–477. [Q1]

Book Chapters

Liu, Y., Tay, D., & Mellow, D. (2025). [Time series](#). In Carol A. Chapelle (Ed.), *The Encyclopaedia of Applied Linguistics*, 2nd edition (pp. 1–7). Wiley.

Liu, Y., & Li, D. (2023). [Xinjiang in Harmony and Prosperity: A Discourse Analysis of Multimodal Metaphor Reframing in a Promotional Video of China's Xinjiang](#). In L. Pan, X. Wu, T. Luo, & H. Qian (Eds.), *Multimodality in Translation Studies: Media, Models, and Trends in China* (pp. 52–80). Routledge.

Liu, Y., & Li, D. (2023). [Metaphor Translation as Reframing: Chinese Versus Western Stance Mediation in COVID-19 News Reports](#). In K. Liu & A. K. F. Cheung (Eds.), *Translation and Interpreting in the Age of COVID-19* (pp. 13–34). Springer.

Book Reviews

Liu, Y. (2024). [Data analytics for discourse analysis with Python—The case of therapy talk](#). Dennis Tay. *Digital Scholarship in the Humanities*, 39(4), 1164–1167. [Q3]

Liu, Y. (2022). [Contesting Epistemologies in Cognitive Translation and Interpreting Studies](#). Halverson, S. L., & García, Á. M. *Across Languages and Cultures*, 24(2), 259-265. [Q3]

Liu, Y. (2019). [Making way in corpus-based interpreting studies](#) [述评《语料库口译研究的出路》]. M. Russo, C. Bendazzoli, & B. Defrancq. *Corpus Linguistics* [语料库语言学], 6(2), 110-114.

Refereed Conference Proceedings

Liu, Y., Payne, S., Rayson, P., Lal, D. M., Korfage, I., Rietjens, J., & Semino, E. (2024). [Cancer experiences in metaphors: A scoping review in 4D PICTURE Project](#). *Palliative Medicine*, 38(Suppl. 2024 EAPC World Research Congress), A05.

Lal, D. M., Rayson, P., Payne, S., & Liu, Y. (2024). [Analysing Emotions in Cancer Narratives: A Corpus-Driven Approach](#). *LREC-COLING*, 73–83.

Pitarch, L., Angles-Herrero, E., Liu, Y., Lal, D. M., Gracia, J., Rayson, P., & Riethens, J. (2024) [Medical-FLAVORS: A Figurative Language and Vocabulary Open Repository for Spanish in the Medical Domain](#). *Proceedings of the First Workshop on Patient-Oriented Language Processing (CL4Health) @ LREC-COLING 2024*. 109-114.

Manuscripts

Liu, Y., Semino, E., Rietjens, J., & Payne, S. (under review). Illness identities and metaphors in online peer-to-peer communication about prostate and ovarian cancer. *Language and Health*. [Q1]

Liu, Y., Semino, E., Hallsson, L. R., Rietjens, J., & Payne, S. (under review). Lived experience of ovarian cancer: An analysis of metaphors in online communication. *Journal of Medical Humanities*. [Q1]

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

Invited Talks

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| 2024 | Liu, Y. Metaphors on two cancer-related online forums — Preliminary findings . At the Palliative Care Research Partnership Northwest Coast (PalCaRe NW) Networking Event. St Catherine’s Hospice. 19 July. |
| 2024 | Liu, Y. Applying time series analysis to (critical) discourse research: Covid metaphors in news reports as a case . University of Exeter. 23 January. |
| 2023 | Liu, Y. Cross-linguistic differences in metaphor use in the COVID-19 news discourse. University of California Berkeley. 23 March. |

Refereed Conference Presentations

- 2026 Liu, Y., & Li, D. Metaphors and China's COVID-19 policies: a diachronic analysis of Chinese-English bilingual news editorials. Corpora & Discourse International Conference 2026. Lancaster University, United Kingdom. 23-25 June.
- 2025 Liu, Y., & Semino, E. Metaphors, identities and gender in online interactions about cancer. The 17th Researching and Applying Metaphor Conference: Metaphor, Technology, and Communication. Lawrence Technological University, United States. 7-10 August.
- 2025 Liu, Y., & Tay, D. Statistical modelling and translation pragmatics: Time series analysis of metaphor translation and re-contextualisation in COVID-19 opinion articles. 19th International Pragmatics Conference. Brisbane, Australia. 22-27 June.
- 2025 Liu, Y., Semino, E., Payne, S., Rayson, P., Lal, D. M., & Rietjens, J. Metaphors, identities and gender on two cancer-related online forums – Insights from the 4D PICTURE Project. 19th World Congress of the European Association for Palliative Care. Helsinki, Finland. 29-31 May.
- 2024 Liu, Y., Payne, S., Rayson, P., Lal, D. M., Korfage, I., Rietjens, J., & Semino, E. Cancer experiences in metaphors: A scoping review in 4D PICTURE Project. The 13th World Research Congress of the European Association for Palliative Care. Barcelona, Spain. 15-18 May.
- 2022 Liu, Y. Translating vaccine metaphors in the age of COVID-19: A case study of *The New York Times's* representation of vaccination in East Asia in news media. The 4th East Asian Translation Studies Conference (EAST4). Université Paris Cité, France. 30 June-2 July.
- 2022 Liu, Y. Multimodal metaphor (re)framing: A critical analysis of the promotional image of China's Hubei province in the post-pandemic era on new media. Virtual talk at the 27th International Conference of the International Association for Intercultural Communication Studies (IAICS). 27 June-1 July.

TEACHING, ASSESSMENT & TRAINING

Invited Workshop & Research-Methods Training

- 2026 Identifying Metaphors in Discourse: Principles, Practices, and Corpus-Based Methods | Shanghai International Studies University
- Invited to design and deliver a research-methods workshop introducing theoretical principles and practical procedures for identifying metaphors in discourse.
 - The workshop will combine systematic metaphor-identification practice with corpus-based methods and authentic discourse data.

Teaching Areas

- Health Communication
- Discourse Analysis
- Corpus Linguistics
- Digital Communication and Social Media

- Science Communication and Public Discourse
- AI-Mediated Communication
- Language, Illness and Identity
- Intercultural and Multilingual Communication
- Qualitative and Quantitative Research Methods
- Figurative Language

Teaching Experience (see also [Academic Employment](#))

- LING421 Corpus Linguistics (PGT), Lancaster University
- FH6301 Theories of Translation (PGT), The Hong Kong Polytechnic University
- CBS4801 Translation Studies (PGT), The Hong Kong Polytechnic University
- CBS1CN06P Translation and Chinese Society (UG), The Hong Kong Polytechnic University
- Corpus Linguistics Summer School Workshops (UG/PG/Researchers), Lancaster University

Assessment Experience

- Co-marked 38 postgraduate coursework submissions for the Lancaster University module LING421 Corpus Linguistics using criteria-based marking and structured written feedback aligned with UK higher education standards.
- Contributed to formative and summative assessment at The Hong Kong Polytechnic University across undergraduate and postgraduate modules, including coursework and examinations.

Teaching Approach

- Student-centred and research-informed teaching.
- Practice-based learning that encourages students to apply theories and methods to real-world challenges.
- Inclusive and supportive teaching that recognises diverse learning and educational backgrounds and promotes accessible learning environments.
- Teaching that encourages critical discussion, collaborative learning and independent analytical thinking.
- Strong emphasis on scaffolded learning, methodological transparency and constructive feedback.

Pedagogical Training

- AI and Trust in Teaching and Assessment (Lancaster University)
- Creative Assessment (Lancaster University)
- Storyboarding Your Modules (Lancaster University)
- Preparing a Team for Marking (Lancaster University)
- Getting Effective Feedback (Lancaster University)
- Small Changes, Big Impact: The Power of Reasonable Adjustments (Lancaster University)
- Becoming An Effective Teaching Assistant (The Hong Kong

Polytechnic University)

Digital Tools & Technologies

- Moodle, Blackboard and Microsoft Teams for blended learning, assessment support and student communication.
- Corpus tools including LancsBox, Wmatrix, Sketch Engine and AntConc.
- NVivo and Python for qualitative and quantitative analysis of digital text data.

MENTORING, SUPERVISION & STUDENT SUPPORT

- Served as a panel member for a PhD student's pre-confirmation review at Lancaster University; provided bespoke feedback on pre-confirmation materials.
- Offered informal research support and advisory guidance to PhD students within Lancaster University's ESRC Centre for Corpus Approaches to Social Science (CASS), particularly on projects relating to metaphor, intercultural communication and online discourse research.
- Mentored and trained CASS colleagues in running the Centre's official LinkedIn social media presence, including post writing, video filming and editing as well as developing content guidelines and delivering a hands-on training session.

ADMINISTRATION, SERVICE AND ENGAGEMENT

Administration and service

2026

Organising Committee Member, Corpora and Discourse International Conference 2026, Lancaster University

- contributed to the preparation and delivery of an international academic conference, supporting pre-conference planning as well as on-site organisation during the event.
- Coordinated conference logistics, provided technical support and ensured the smooth running of parallel sessions.
- chaired one conference session, supported speakers and delegates, and worked collaboratively with colleagues to resolve operational issues in a fast-paced conference environment.

2025-Present

Secretary, British Association for Applied Linguistics Health and Science Communication Special Interest Group

- supported administration of the Special Interest Group (SIG) activities, including taking minutes, documenting decisions, and maintaining accurate records.
- assisted with the SIG research activities and events, providing logistical and administrative support as required.

2024-2025

Research associate representative, Linguistics and English Language Research Committee, Lancaster University

- acted as liaison for early-career researchers, facilitating communication between research staff and senior management.

- o participated in departmental meetings and contributed to planning departmental research-related events and initiatives.

Engagement

2023-2026	Participated in regular Public and Patient Involvement (PPI) meetings to communicate research findings and engage with public stakeholders.
2026	Volunteered at <i>Campus in the City</i> (Lancaster University), facilitating interactive public engagement activities on muscle movement and bone health for children, students and families.
2026	Contributed to a rapid-response mini research project and presentation titled <i>Energy Coverage in the UK Press (2020–2026)</i> for the Czech Ambassador to the UK and accompanying delegation, demonstrating applications of corpus linguistics and discourse analysis in energy and media communication research.
2026	Participated in discussions during the Vice-Chancellor's visit to Lancaster University's ESRC Centre for Corpus Approaches to Social Science, contributing examples of the use of corpus linguistic methods in social science research.
2024	Presented cancer communication research to UK Research and Innovation representatives during their visit to Lancaster University's ESRC Centre for Corpus Approaches to Social Science.
2024	Contributor to the 4D PICTURE podcast series discussing metaphor and cancer communication.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

The International Consortium for Communication in Health Care (IC4CH)

The Health and Science Communication Special Interest Group of the British Association for Applied Linguistics

The Association for Researching and Applying Metaphor (RaAM)

The British Academy Early Career Researcher Network

The International Association for Intercultural Communication Studies (IAICS)

The International Pragmatics Association (IPrA)

REVIEWING SERVICE

I have reviewed manuscripts for journals including:

Health Communication

BMC Public Health

Social Science & Medicine

Humanities and Social Sciences Communications

Text & Talk

Discourse, Context & Media

Digital Scholarship in the Humanities

Social Semiotics

Metaphor and Symbol

Metaphors and the Social World

Lingua

Applied Corpus Linguistics

Book reviewer for Routledge, with reviews covering work in discourse analysis and computational approaches to language

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

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| 2024 | Faculty of Humanities Distinguished Thesis Award for PhD Students 2023/24, The Hong Kong Polytechnic University |
| 2022 | Faculty of Humanities Outstanding Publication Award for PhD/Doctoral Students 2021/22, The Hong Kong Polytechnic University |
| 2022 | The Hong Kong Special Administrative Region Government Scholarship—Reaching Out Award 2021/22, The Hong Kong Special Administrative Region Government |
| 2022 | The Hong Kong, China-Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation Scholarship 2021/22, The Ministry of Education of Hong Kong SAR |
| 2020-2023 | Ph.D. Student Fellowship, The Hong Kong Polytechnic University |

RESEARCH METHODS & SOFTWARE

Corpus linguistic methods

Discourse analysis

Metaphor analysis

Statistical modelling

Sketch Engine, LancsBox, Wmatrix, AntConc

NVivo, MAXQDA

IBM SPSS

Python, R

LANGUAGES

Mandarin (native), **English** (advanced professional), **Cantonese** (limited working proficiency), **Spanish** (intermediate), **Japanese** (elementary), **German** (elementary)